

100-YEAR HISTORY WALK – ST JOSEPH’S CATHOLIC SCHOOL



Many of the new settlers in the district were Catholic and in 1878 Mr John McInerney donated two acres of land, three miles south-east of the proposed railway line and four miles east of Yongala to build a church. The Church of Saint Sabastian was established by the Rev. Father John Evangelist Pallhuber S J originally of Sevenhills and then of Tarcowie. A private school was also conducted in the church. The church picnics were held in the paddock next to the church.

The Rev. Father Bernard Nevin of Pekina held services at the church until 1881, when he was replaced by the Rev. Father James Mahar also of Pekina (future Bishop of Port Augusta). The Rev. Father Pallhuber S J, relocated to Jamestown in 1882 where he died in 1890 aged 68.

In November 1878, Bishop Reynolds, the Roman Catholic Bishop of Adelaide visited the church during his tour of the north. The Chapel School was consecrated by the Bishop in honour of Saint Sabastian the Martyr and he administered the sacrament of confirmation to twelve young people.

The Rev. Father John Norton was the first Catholic priest to live in Petersburg. Rev Norton arrived at Petersburg on 19th January 1884 and took over the services at the Church of Saint Sabastian. An old house was soon purchased, and the Rev Father Norton began holding regular mass in Petersburg.

The original Methodist Church, an iron building built in 1880 by Mr George Threadgold between the Main Street and Railway Terrace was sold to the Catholic Church and became the first Church of Anacletus.

The new Catholic Church was opened on Sunday 23rd November 1884. The ceremony of dedicating and blessing St Anacletus Catholic Church was conducted by His Lordship the Right Rev CA Reynolds, followed by Holy Mass by Father O'Brien. Under the direction of Father Norton several additions and alterations had been made to the building by Mr Jabez Wright. A sanctuary and sacristy have been added to the western gable, and a porch erected over the entrance. An altar chastely designed and decorated was erected, and the windows were of coloured glass. A bell was provided to summon the worshippers, and two crosses ornamented the gables.

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The new Catholic School opened a few weeks later in December 1884 using the church as a classroom with Miss Teresa Ennis a provisional teacher. She was replaced by Miss Marie O'Loughlin in 1885 when she resumed her studies. By 1892 the number of students had risen, and an assistant Miss McGreavy was engaged to help.



Miss Marie O'Loughlin and students
Photo – Peterborough Library History Room

End of year concerts were held at the town hall, and regular fundraising events were held by parents to raise money for both the church and school. Examinations were held each year, and the school proudly displayed the children's work with open displays.

Petersburg Times
Friday 6 January 1888

Petersburg Catholic School.

The annual examination and display of this school took place last week. On Monday and Tuesday, the 19th and 20th December, the children attending the school to the number of sixty (out of about seventy on the books) presented themselves to be examined by the Rev. Father Norton, who subjected them to the most rigorous questioning. The children, however, were equal to the task, and it must be said that, with one or two exceptions, they all passed their examinations very creditably. This examination was private, but on Thursday, December 22, the usual annual display was held, when the children met to perform several little academic exercises in the presence of their parents and friends, acquitting themselves very creditably. There was a large variety of songs and choruses, serving to bring out the musical abilities of the little ones, and for children so young showed a marked improvement in this respect. The elocutionary exercises, consisting of recitations and dialogues, were, on the whole,

very creditably delivered. The opening chorus, 'Annie of the vale,' was sung with great precision and sweetness. The same may be said of the other selections, 'Rouse, brothers rouse,' 'The soldiers chorus,' from Faust, which though difficult, was sung with great spirit, 'The song of Australia,' and the 'Hens' Convention.' The melodies, 'Believe me if all those endearing young charms,' and 'Let Erin remember the days of old,' were very sweetly sung by Misses Annie Hill, E. Owens, J. Critchley, and May O'Hare, the whole of the children repeating the verses in chorus. The 'Young May Moon' was nicely sung by Joseph Hill, and chorused by the scholars. Among the recitations the most notable were 'The Voice of spring' by Miss Helena Owens; 'Little Jim,' by Annie Hill; 'The Young Orator,' by James Fay; 'The Child and the Bird,' a dialogue by Misses J. Critchley and E. Owens; 'The Spider and the Fly,' by Bridget Bennett. The children being rather young, they have not had sufficient time to perfect themselves in this respect, but it was remarkable that the youngest acquitted themselves generally the best.

After the display was finished the Rev. Father Norton congratulated the children on the success they had attained in their examinations and other exercises during the past year, urging the children to work still harder during the coming year. He then distributed a large number of prizes to the most deserving in order of merit and general excellence in their various classes. The following is a list of the scholars in order of merit, and to whom prizes were awarded:—

Junior divisions—first—W. Sheridan, P. McManus, J. Skehan, B. Hill. Second division—R. Clarke, P. Moore, F. Browne, W. Clarke, J. Sheridan.

First class—A. Brady, H. Brady, M. Lynch, F. Crotty, M. Wright, M. E. Wright, M. Crotty, J. O'Hare, J. Lynch, A. Preece, M. Delaney, J. Reid.

Second class—M. O'Hare, E. Owens, (equal), J. McNamara, J. Critchley, H. Clarke, G. Moore, K. Cochrane, E. Sheridan, W. Hill, R. Reed, M. Reed, H. Bennett, S. Critchley, W. Fitzgerald, G. Delaney, B. Malycha.

Third class—J. Fay, J. Cochrane, A. Hill, H. Rabbich, J. Hill, T. O'Brien, B. Bennett, H. Owens,

Fourth class—Jas. Cochrane, P. Fay, J. O'Brien.

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The annual Catholic Picnic was held on Tuesday 1st November 1887 and despite the threat of rain over four hundred people attended the day. A hot north wind blew dust across Mr Cochrane’s paddock all day but this did not deter the attendance. Mass was celebrated at St Anacletus Catholic Church at 10:30am with the sports program starting at 12pm. A concert followed by a ball were held in the evening with about £100 raised for the Catholic Church building fund.

The annual Catholic picnic and sports were held annually on 1st January usually at either the Lancelot Lagoon or Hutton’s Lagoon and on All Saints Day in November at Petersburg.

A picnic was held on 25th August 1887 for the children of the district. The picnic was organised by the Catholic Church and was held near the Seven Mile Yard on the Silverton Line. This was possibly the future site of Amilia Park Picnic Ground.

Tenders were called for the building of a new Catholic church in 1890. The building was planned to be of a substantial character, and an ornament to the town. The foundation stone was to be laid at the end of the month by Bishop O’Reily. The church would be built in Railway Street alongside the priests’ residence on the south side of the town.

The New Catholic School-Church, Petersburg.

Next Sunday, the 28th September, will, we believe, prove a red-letter day in the annals of the Catholic community of Petersburg. The day will be marked by the ceremony of solemnly blessing the foundation stone of a new School - Church. His Lordship the Bishop of Port Augusta, the Right Rev. Dr. O’Reily, is to perform the ceremony and deliver an address. We anticipate a large attendance on Sunday, especially if the weather proves propitious. Holy Masses are announced for 8 and 11 o’clock a.m. in the church, and the ceremony of the foundation stone is to begin at 3 in the afternoon. The usual evening services will be held at 7 p.m. in the church.

The following description of the new edifice should prove of interest to our readers. The building, which has already been commenced, is to be in the Gothic style of architecture, and is to be of stone throughout, the stone being obtained in the neighbourhood of Petersburg. The site is alongside the priests’ residence in Railway Street on the south side of the township. The dimensions of the church are 65 feet by 30 feet clear. The concrete footing courses and the foundation walls are of a substantial character, the former

being 3 ft. 6 in. thick, and the latter 2 ft. 6 in. The main walls are to be 2 feet thick throughout, and 18 feet high from the floor to the wall plate. The stone work of walls will be of random coursed masonry neatly pointed on the exterior with line of black zinc paint. The quoins and window and door and other dressings will be fine chisel-dressed and the gables will be finished with neat cement coping. The building will be entered through a spacious porch 14 feet 6 inches clear, fitted with solidly framed folding doors, and opened framed roof, and ceiling, and lighted by a Gothic window of embossed cathedral glass. The main body of the church will be entered from the porch by green baize folding doors, and the view of the sanctuary, altar, and sacristies at either side will be particularly striking, and calculated to lend a furnished appearance to the whole interior. The Altar will be seated at the southern extremity and will be tastefully decorated. A neat communion rail will divide the sanctuary from the rest of the church. The sacristies will be of woodwork, solidly framed and crowned with neatly wrought and moulded entablature, and faced with moulded panels and pilasters, with suitable caps and bases, and the

whole will be picked out in various shades and gilded. The church benches will be neat and substantial. The walls on the inside are to be executed in imitation of ashlar; while the roof will be open framed with six pairs of principals, king posts, collar beams, and diagonal ties firmly braced together. The ceilings will be of match-boarding to be picked out together with the entire roof timbers in varied tints of stain and varnish. The windows which will be of cathedral glass embossed, will be eleven in number (including a triple light in the main front gable). Due provision will be made for ventilation in the walls, and in the roof by ornamental galvanized iron ventilators, and the gables will be surmounted by neat crosses. The contractors for the entire works are Messrs. Colligan and Goodenough, of East Adelaide. The foundation stone, which will be blessed on next Sunday, has been generously presented to the Rev. Father Norton for the Church by the Ex-mayor of Adelaide, James Shaw, Esq., and it is a magnificent piece of Kapunda marble suitably inscribed. The plans and specifications of the new building were prepared solely by the Rev. Father Norton and the entire works will be carried out under his superintendence.

Petersburg Times
Friday 26 September 1890

Although not completed, church services were held at the new Catholic Church for the first time on Christmas Day 1890. The formal opening of the church was not scheduled until a later date.

100-YEAR HISTORY WALK – ST JOSEPH'S CATHOLIC SCHOOL

The formal opening of St Anacletus, the new Catholic Church was held on Sunday 11th September 1892. The blessing was performed by the Right Rev. Dr O'Reilly, Bishop of Port Augusta.

Petersburg St Anacletus Catholic Church
Photo – Lionel Noble Collection



On Saturday 30th July 1892 an exciting game of football was held between the Public-school boys and the Catholic-school boys. As no goals were scored the game resulted in a draw with the Public School, 5 behinds and the Catholic School, 2 behinds.

The thirteenth Catholic Picnic was held at the Petersburg Show Grounds on 28th October 1896.

Petersburg Catholic Picnic.

The thirteenth annual Catholic picnic was held at Petersburg on the show grounds on the 28th inst. It is now just about nineteen years since the demonstration was first initiated. From 1878 to 1883 it was usually held on the grounds near St. Sebastian's church, which was for several years used as a Catholic school church. In 1884 the celebration of All Saints' Day as a regular annual thing at Petersburg began, for it was in January of that year that a resident priest was for the first time located in the town. All Saints' Day falls on the first day of November, but as it coincides with Sunday this year, the customary festivities were arranged for Wednesday last. The day's proceedings began at St. Anacletus' church, the festival being that of Saint Simon and Jude, Apostles. Holy Mass was sung by the Very Rev. Father Norton, V.G., the pastor of the district, at 10.30 a.m. The choir, under Mr A. Malycha as conductor, and Miss H. Brady as organist, rendering Webbe's mass in A, the *Credo* being from Webbe in G. A fairly large congregation occupied the building. The mass ended, the thoughts of all turned to the picnic grounds, and thither they at once directed their steps. As one entered the gates there might be seen the large marquee of Messrs Williams and Rowe's steam riding gallery, which was a centre of attraction for the younger fry and the ladies during the day. Holding the fort at the portals were Messrs James O'Brien, sen., M. J. Howard, and J. McEntee, who defended the position courageously and well, taking in and welcoming the solvent friends and excluding the penniless foes. No blood was, however, shed. The day was anything but pleasant during the earlier portion of the afternoon on account of the intense heat. As the evening wore on the temperature became

more pleasant. Notwithstanding all drawbacks from the dryness of the season, scarcity of cash, and the sultriness of the day, the attendance was very fair; about 300 persons passed through the gates. The usual programme of athletic contests, items for the younger competitors being here and there interspersed, with three bicycle events, served to while away a pleasant few hours. The days arrangements were under the supervision of the Very Rev. Father Norton, and Father Ward was also on the ground. The energetic and painstaking secretary (Mr W. Thomson) entered heart and soul into his duties, and his task was no light one. He was ably assisted by the judges (Messrs R. Cochrane, J.P., Jas. McGuire, A. Dowd, and D. Naughton.) The handicappers, Messrs D. Roberts, T. Wallace and W. Waters also kindly contributed to the smoothness of the business, while Messrs F. C. Staer and D. McKeough's office of referees was more or less a sinecure. Mr Staer was nevertheless busy catering for the amusement of the youngsters. Mr P. Crowley made an excellent starter. Mr P. Callary was *au fait* as master of track. Messrs J. O'Hare, T. O'Neil, Jas. Smith, W. and J. Pilkington, H. Critchley and J. Lee lent valuable assistance to the picnic in various other ways. The pavilion was the scene of the ladies operations. There a large amount of innocent slaughtering was done. The wings and legs and sundry pieces of fowl or other flesh with various delicate viands were soon disposed of. The genial and hospitable Mrs T. Conlon, who was the hostess of the day, spared nothing to entertain her patrons. In her arduous work she was helped by Mrs W. and J. Pilkington, Mrs Sheridan, Mrs G. Holland, Mrs Naughton, sen., Mrs McGuire, the Misses Howard (2), C. Smith (Yongala), O'Sullivan and Conlon. The ladies deserve great credit for their efforts. Through some

music of Messrs Williams and Rowe's steam organ supplied the deficiency, and it never got out of breath. The little black conductor's handle never grew tired. The object of the demonstration is to wipe out the remnant of debt in connection with S. Anacletus' church. We trust this praiseworthy end may be more than secured. The following is the list of successful competitors:—

H.A.C.B.S. Handicap, 100 yards.—First, P. Fay, 10s; second, D. Blunsden, 5s.

Handicap Flat Race, 3 events.—First event, 100 yards: First, J. Wisdom, 8 yards; second, A. Wilson, 10 yards; third, J. Fay, 8 yards. Second Event, 135 yards.—First, J. Fay, 6 yards; second, A. Wilson, 8 yards; third, P. O'Brien, 4 yards. Third Event, 150 yards.—First, J. Fay, 8 yards; second, A. Wilson, 10 yards; third, P. O'Brien, 2 yards. The final result of points was J. Fay, first, 43; A. Wilson, second, 30s; J. Wisdom, third, 10s.

Boys' Race (under 14 years).—First, A. Conlon, cricket set (presented by Mr Morphett); second, M. Casey, 2s 6d.

Cigar Race.—First, T. Snigg, 10s; second, J. Williams, 5s.

Egg and Spoon Race.—First, F. Symon, 7s 6d; second, P. O'Brien, 2s 6d.

Boys' Boot Race.—First, F. McKenzie, 5s; second, H. Dunchue, 2s 6d.

Handicap Bicycle Race. 2 miles.—First, W. Gage (125 yards) 42; second, F. Horner (200 yards) 41. Five started.

Bicycle Race. 1 mile. For all who had not won an advertised race.—A. Potter (20 yards), 41; W. Nicol (40 yards), 10s. Five started.

Bicycle Sweepstake. 1 mile.—First, F. Edmonds, 100 yards; second, W. Gage, 100 yards, third, O. Bottrill, 20 yards. Five started.

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Miss O’Loughlin, teacher at the Catholic School retired in 1896 after twelve years and the school was to be taken over by the Sisters of St. Joseph. She was presented with an address and album from the children of the school.

The Sisters of St Joseph began operating the Catholic school. Founder of the order, Mary McKillop, and four nuns (Sisters Benizi (sister in charge), Aloysuis, Clotide and Euphrasia) arrived on 16 January 1897 and were met at the station by Father Norton.

The pupils of the Petersburg Catholic School, conducted by the Sisters of St Joseph, gave a most successful concert in the Town Hall on Friday 1st October 1897.

A Commonwealth Fair was held in the Town Hall on 21st to 25th March 1902 by the Catholic Church. It was to raise funds to erect a new and more convenient Presbytery at Petersburg. The fair was a great success with about 400 persons having paid admission over the five days.

The ‘months mind’ requiem for the Roman Catholic Bishop of Port August, the Right Rev. Dr James Maher was held on Wednesday 24th January at St Anacletus Church. Dr Maher was Rev Father at the Church of Saint Sabastian between 1881 and 1884 until he was replaced by the Rev Father John Norton. Dr Maher died on 20th December 1905 at his home at Pekina after a painful illness aged 66.

The Very Rev. JH Norton (who had been Administer of the Diocese since the death of Dr Maher) received the documents of his appointment to the Bishopric of Port Augusta.



*The Right Rev. John Henry Norton, Bishop of Port Augusta
Photo – Lionel Noble Collection*

Among the many telegraphic messages received by the Right Rev. Dr. Norton, the Bishop-elect of Port Augusta, His Worship the Mayor of Petersburg, W. A. L. Casely, Esq., sent the following from Adelaide on Friday, 5th inst:—"Allow me on behalf of the ratepayers of Petersburg to express the gratification we feel at the appreciation of your services as manifested by your appointment to the Bishopric of PortAugusta." To this the Bishop-elect replied as follows:—"As Mayor of this important centre, I sincerely thank you and the citizens of Petersburg for your warm congratulations. May we all as becometh true citizens ever be cordially united for the common good."

*Petersburg Times
Tuesday 9th October 1906*

100-YEAR HISTORY WALK – ST JOSEPH'S CATHOLIC SCHOOL

The Silver Jubilee of the St Joseph's Catholic School was held in St Anacletus Hall on Wednesday 22nd December 1910.

St. Joseph's Catholic School Petersburg.

— The Silver Jubilee. —

The silver jubilee of this school was celebrated on Wednesday, December 22 in St. Anacletus Hall, when the results of the 25th annual examination and the prizes to successful pupils were distributed. The gathering was a large one, consisting of the children to the number of over a hundred and their parents and friends. The Bishop of Port Augusta (the Right Rev. Dr. Norton) presided and was supported by the Rev. Father J. G. O'Rourke.

A musical programme was carried out by the children in which the principal items were the hymn "Adeste Fideles," a chorus entitled "Heart to Heart," two dialogues on Irish and Australian history by the higher classes, two action songs, "Japloo Baby" and "Good Night" by the small girls, the whole concluding with "A Song for the Pope."

At the conclusion of the entertainment, which was much enjoyed and in which the children acquitted themselves very creditably, His Lordship the Bishop addressed the assemblage. He congratulated the Sisters and the

pupils on their performance that evening and explained how the school had been carried on for a full quarter of a century without a penny of assistance or a word of recognition by the State. The Catholics throughout Australasia were in the same plight having to find the money for their own schools, as well as contributing to the cost of the State system. The Bishop was sorry the silver jubilee of the school was being passed over so lightly and was not receiving the consideration it ought as it was certainly a great event and a big triumph for the Catholics to have successfully maintained their school at Petersburg for twenty-five years, many of them of drought and distress. Petersburg seemed callous and insensible in the celebration of jubilees. They might have sent their children to the State-supported school for the whole twenty-five years and saved themselves thousands of pounds, but the Catholic conscience was based on the belief in certain divine truths or verities which had a peculiar binding force to secure at any cost a truly religious and moral training of the child in conjunction with an intellectual education. The Bishop wished the Sisters of St. Joseph, the pupils, parents, and all present, a pleasant and Happy Christmas and a bright and prosperous New Year. He hoped they would all be spared

to see the golden jubilee of the school.

The Bishop afterwards distributed the prizes. He complimented the Rev. Father O'Rourke on the examination just completed, and thanked him for the patience he brought to the task. Prizes were given to the various classes from the junior up to the 6th form. Many special premiums were awarded for special subjects, such as Irish and Australian History, plain and fancy needlework, attendance at day school and catechism on Sundays, and for the serving of Holy Mass in the Church. The St. Anacletus local branch of the H.A.C.B. Society donated the prizes for Irish History, the Rev. Father O'Rourke that for Australian history. The Bishop provided the rest of the books.

There was a magnificent display of plain and fancy needlework wrought by the pupils at one end of the hall. The Bishop noted during the evening that the school had secured 53 prizes at Petersburg late show. The Sisters of St. Joseph are to be congratulated upon so successful a year's work and the Catholic body deserves to be recognised in their effort to make good citizens by fighting for a religious education for their children.

Petersburg Times
Friday 7 January 1910

The new residence for the Catholic Bishop of Port Augusta was formally opened and blessed by the Right Rev. Dr JH Norton. The building was an imposing two story stone structure, with 14 rooms and accessories. Stables and outhouses were erected with every convenience. A large underground tank had been constructed, with rotary pump to lift the water to the upper story. The residence was built near the St Anacletus Church. It also had its own electricity supply for lighting.



The new Catholic 'Bishop's House' - 1913
Photo – Lionel Noble Collection

100-YEAR HISTORY WALK – ST JOSEPH'S CATHOLIC SCHOOL

The Right Rev John Henry Norton, Bishop of Port Augusta, died on Thursday 22nd March 1923 after a long illness.

Although suffering a relapse from his recent illness, and the announcement on Wednesday evening that Dr. Norton, Bishop of Port Augusta, was very low, the sad news of his death on Thursday morning came as a great shock to the whole State, throughout which His Lordship was well known and beloved by all.

When Rev Norton arrived at Peterborough (Petersburg) on 19th January 1884, it was a small township of about 300 people. There was no Catholic institution in the town, and he was the priest at the Catholic Church of St Sebastian on land owned by Mr McInerney, three miles south-east of the town, between Peterborough and Yongala. The church purchased a small house and Rev Father Norton conducted services from there until the later part of 1884, when the old iron church formally used by the Peterborough Methodists was purchased. Under the direction of Rev Norton, who was a trained architect, several additions and alterations were made, and the building became the first St Anacletus Church. The Church was opened on Sunday 23rd November and was also used as a school, which opened in December 1884. In 1885 the foundation stone of the Dawson Church was laid by Bishop Reynolds, and Blessed by Father Norton January 1887, but formally opened by Bishop Reynolds in August of the same year. Monthly services were held in the Yongala Institute until the purchase of the old Methodist Church in 1904. The second Church of St Anacletus was built in 1890 and formally opened on Sunday 11th September 1892. The church was enlarged in 1916 and officially opened on 5th August 1917. The two-story Bishop's residence which was designed by Rev Norton was completed in 1913.

The consecration of the new Bishop of Port Augusta, The Right Rev. Andrew Killian of Broken Hill was held at St Anacletus Catholic Church on Sunday 15th June 1924.

The foundation stone for a new Catholic school, which was to be built as a memorial for the late Bishop (The Right Rev Dr Norton) was blessed and laid by the present Bishop (The Rev Dr Andrew Killian) on Sunday 19th April 1925.

Transcontinental
Friday 24 April 1925

From Peterborough's

Roman Catholic members of Peterborough have been working hard throughout the year in an effort to open the new Memorial School free of debt. Much enthusiasm and energy has been displayed by women and men, and the crowning effort was begun when the Right Rev. Dr. A. Killian (Bishop of Port Augusta) declared the monster fair and continental open in St. Anacletus' Hall, as a result of which the end of the debt contracted at the school is well in view.

News
Tuesday 3 December 1925

Memorial School at Peterborough.

On Sunday last the foundation-stone of the Catholic school, which is being built as a memorial to the former Bishop of Port Augusta (Dr. Norton), was blessed and laid by the present Bishop (Dr. Andrew Killian) in the presence of one of the largest gatherings seen in Peterborough for some time. The stone bears the following inscription— "This stone is erected to the memory of the Right Rev. Dr. Norton, Bishop of Port Augusta, 1906-1923." In response to an appeal by Dr. Killian for funds, \$600 was collected.

100-YEAR HISTORY WALK – ST JOSEPH'S CATHOLIC SCHOOL

The new St Joseph's Catholic School was opened on 24th January, by the Right Rev Dr Killian. The school was built as a memorial to the late Dr. John Henry Norton, Roman Catholic Bishop of Port Augusta. The school opened free of debt as the Catholics of the district were able to raise all the money for the school, furniture and accessories.

MEMORIAL SCHOOL.

Opened at Peterborough.

The new memorial school, erected to the memory of the late Dr. John Henry Norton, Roman Catholic Bishop of Port Augusta, was opened at Peterborough on Sunday last by the Right Rev. Dr. Killian, the present bishop. Although the scheme was inaugurated only three years ago all the money necessary to free the undertaking of debt had been realized at the close of to-day's ceremony.

St. Anacletus Pro. Cathedral was well filled. At the close of the service the bishop, assisted by Archdeacon Doyle (Jamestown), the Very Rev. Father O'Rourke (Port Pirie), Very Rev. Father Ryan (Peterborough), and the Rev. Father Morrissey (Pekina) conducted the preparatory service of asking God's blessing on the undertaking.

The Ceremony.

A procession was then formed, headed by the crossbearers and acolytes, who were followed by the girls, the Sisters of St. Joseph, the boys, the H.A.C.B. Society, and the clergy, to the new school, where the bishop blessed and formally declared the building open, after which he extended a very hearty welcome to the Mayor (Mr. W. C. Reed) and the members for the district (Messrs. O'Halloran, McHugh, and Hawke). Particularly did he thank the visiting clergy. The speaker eulogized the late Bishop Norton, who had come to Peterborough as a young man in the early days of his priesthood, and had spent the remainder of his earthly life among them, building up the faith and adorning the parish with many fine buildings for religious and educational purposes. The architect and the builder (Mr. W. Brady) and his staff had ably carried out their duties, and the building was in every way a great credit to them. Of the memorial they were all justly proud. Dr. Killian spoke at considerable length upon the material aspect and the moral significance of the edifice, and he quoted the American President's strongly expressed opinion on the great necessity of Christian education, without which no Government or country could stand.

Mr. O'Halloran moved—"That this meeting of the Catholics and citizens of Peterborough desire to place on record their expression of gratitude to all who had co-operated in building and freeing from all debt this fine memorial school."

Messrs. McHugh and A. R. G. Hawke, M.P.'s. supported.

The Very Rev. Father O'Rourke, who had been many years connected with Peterborough, spoke of the great work carried out by the late bishop, particularly at Peterborough.

The Very Rev. Father Ryan referred to the great enthusiasm and energy shown by the people of Peterborough parish and their determination to open the school free of debt. The collection that day, amounting to £350, had accomplished that end. (Applause.) All were very happy and proud of their achievement, and their thanks went out to those who had assisted them. Beginning in 1922, they had raised £3,820. The cost of the building, out-buildings, fencing, underground, and all equipment, had cost £3,800, and was paid for in full.

The Mayor, in proposing a vote of thanks to the bishop for presiding, commended the Catholics of Peterborough on the result of their effort and upon the memorial erected to the late bishop. He hoped Dr. Killian and those who had worked so hard to bring about success would live long to enjoy the prosperity of the children benefiting by the great privileges that were being provided for them.

The bishop, in responding, announced that on May 1 the new bishop's house would be blessed and opened and the present two-story building handed over to the Sisters of St. Joseph, as a convent and a small boys' boarding school.

The Building.

The new school, which stands prominently on the corner of Bourke and Cullary streets, is an imposing structure of dressed stone, very lofty, and the main room is beautifully lighted by 15 large Gothic windows on the eastern side. This room is divided into three spacious classrooms with folding doors. Two large classrooms for the higher grades are on the west side. In the front a large statue of St. Joseph stands in a niche in the wall. All the latest of modern furnishings had been provided and the whole is in every way a fitting and lasting memorial.

100-YEAR HISTORY WALK – ST JOSEPH'S CATHOLIC SCHOOL



Dr Norton Memorial School- 1926
Photo – Lionel Noble Collection

Dr Killian also announced that the new bishop's house would be blessed and opened on 2nd May and the present two story building handed over to the Sister's of St Joseph, as a convent and a small boys' boarding school.

THE BLESSING AND PUBLIC MEETING.

At 3-o'clock in the afternoon, amid rain and very heavy winds, a large gathering assembled and, although every available spot in the church was occupied, a large number were unable to gain admittance. Owing to the inclement weather the procession and open-air meeting had to be abandoned, and, after the Blessing and Dedication of the new buildings, the Blessed Sacrament was removed from the tabernacle and the public meeting held in the church.

HIS LORDSHIP DR. KILLIAN.

Dr. Killian opened by introducing his distinguished visitors, and, at the same time, apologized for several other distinguished clergy who, owing to various reasons, were unable to be present. In introducing the Archbishop of Wellington, he named him as the patriarch of the whole church, he being the oldest reigning bishop in the Catholic Church. It was a wonderful honour to have the presence of

the Archbishop of Wellington. He expressed to the visitors the thanks and gratitude of the whole of the people in the diocese for the honour conferred upon them, and stated that he would always be ready to assist their Lordships and Graces in any work in their own dioceses.

He thought it would be some help if he put his case before this great audience. When he came to this diocese he received a splendid inheritance. He received a diocese well organized, debts securely in hand and practically mostly liquidated. His predecessor was a man of consuming love for the church, and spent his all for the glory of God and the advancement of His holy religion. Thanks to the splendid generosity of the people of the parish, a beautiful school had been built to the memory of Dr. Norton, and this school had been built at a cost of £1,800, and yet it had been opened free from debt and stood to-day as a monument in the memory of their late Bishop, Dr. Norton.

Further, they had been able to do something for the Sisters. The Sisters had been working and living un-

der conditions which no Catholic could take any pride in. The question had arisen of providing the Sisters with a Convent. The cost of the Convent would have been a very large amount, and the thought had come into his mind, after he had made a complete visitation of the whole of the diocese, that it would be a good plan to perpetuate, in a still more marked manner, the memory of the Bishop who placed this diocese on its feet — Dr. Norton. He thought it would be well to hand over the Bishop's House to the Sisters for use as a Convent, for the education of boys in the parish and its surroundings. He therefore determined to turn the Bishop's Palace into a convent, a boarding school for little boys up to twelve or thirteen years of age. He wished the people to understand that the debt which had been incurred in the erection of the Bishop's House was purely in order that a Convent might be given to the Sisters. In providing this Convent they had to build a house, and therefore the debt which was incurred was really a debt on the new Convent. He had the greatest confidence that the idea was practical and that it would be blessed by Almighty God.

100-YEAR HISTORY WALK – ST JOSEPH’S CATHOLIC SCHOOL

The boarding school later became a girls boarding school in 1940 and additions to the school were built in 1957 as the enrolments totalled over 300.

In 1931 summer school was established for outback students. The students were accommodated in the convent and St Anacletus Hall. The summer school ran until the 1960’s although there were not held in the war years due to the scarcity of fuel.

News
Friday 16 January 1931

Catholic Summer School

PETERBOROUGH, Today

Catholics are preparing for the establishment of a summer school of religious instruction at Peterborough. A special staff has volunteered from St Joseph's Order to conduct the school.

About 40 girls from the outback are expected to arrive today. A number of them will be accommodated in the convent, and the remainder in St Anacletus' Hall, which is being fitted up as a dormitory. The girls will conclude their week on January 23. More than 40 boys will arrive next day, and stay until the following Saturday.

The scheme is new in South Australia. In addition to religious education a recreation programme is being arranged.

The boarding school was closed in 1973 and the secondary section of the school was closed in 1974.

The school was completely refurbished in 1988 and further additions have been added since.

